EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Canadian Crime, 2025

Overall crime eased in 2025 — but only modestly, and not everywhere. A first turn down after a decade of rising severity.

Prepared for the Executive Team · August 2026

T L ; D R

A mixed picture — headlines down, but only a little

−4.86%

Crime Severity Index

Second straight annual decline — but CSI is still 14% above its 2014 low.

−2.4%

Overall crime rate

Per 100,000 population, vs. 2024. A modest give-back.

+2.35%

Weighted clearance rate

Reversing a decade-long slide.

−16.5%

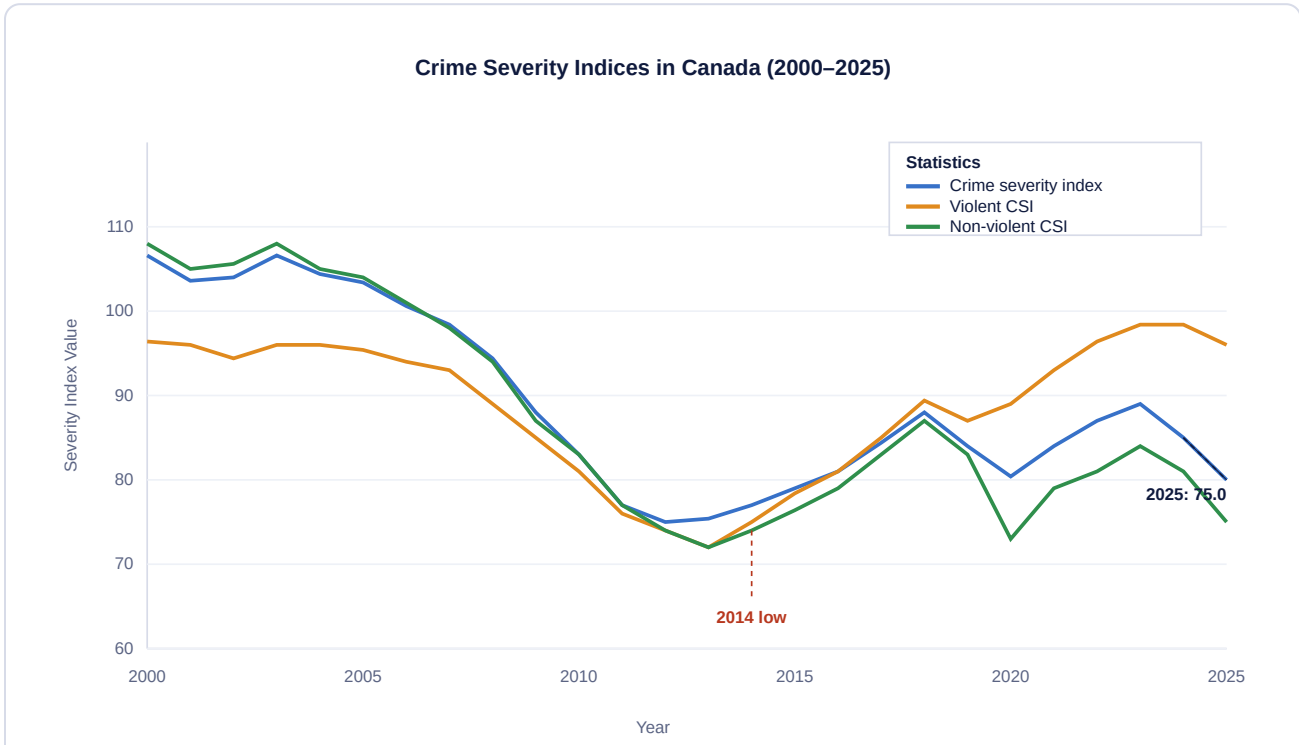
Homicide rate

First-degree murder down 23.7%.

Headlines moved down and clearance moved up — but the improvement is small next to a decade of increases.

THE LONG VIEW

Crime Severity Index — a small step back after a long climb



What the line shows

Overall CSI fell from 106.7 in 2000 to 75.0 in 2025 — but it is **still ~14% above the 2014 low** of roughly 66.

A modest reversal, not a return

Violent CSI climbed almost every year from 2014 through 2024. 2025's dip walks back only a fraction of that decade-long climb.

Non-violent led the improvement

Non-violent CSI drives most of 2025's improvement — down 5.3% year over year.

Statistics Canada, 2000–2025

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release

THE GOOD NEWS

Improvement across most major categories

01 Violent crime

−16.5% Homicide rate

−23.7% First-degree murder rate

−15.0% Attempted murder rate

Deep declines in the most serious offences.

02 Property crime

−16.4% Motor-vehicle theft rate

−10.6% Breaking & entering rate

−3.8% Total property crime rate

Big-ticket property crimes fell sharply.

03 Cyber, organized & hate

2nd yr Cybercrime — second year of decline

1st yr Organized crime — first drop since 2021

−3% Hate crime incidents

All three categories saw declines in 2025 vs. 2024.

Year-over-year change vs. 2024 · rates per 100,000 population

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release

BUT NOT EVERYWHERE

Serious offences that still moved the wrong way

+4.10%

Arson, disregard for human life

Rate per 100,000 population · the most dangerous arson category rose against a falling overall trend.

+3.49%

Sexual assault, level 2 (weapon or bodily harm)

Aggravated sexual assault categories moved unevenly — level 1 was −1.22%, level 3 was −3.19%, but level 2 climbed.

+16.7%

Trafficking in stolen property

The sharpest jump in the property-crime table — even as motor-vehicle theft and B&E fell sharply.

+11.4%

Shoplifting $5,000 or under

Now 501.6 per 100,000 — continues to run against the broader property-crime decline.

+2.66%

Theft over $5,000

One of the few high-value property categories to rise year over year.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The overall picture is down, but **the headline masks pockets that got worse** — and two of them (arson-with-disregard-for-life and level-2 sexual assault) sit at the serious end of the harm scale.

These are the offences to **flag for programme leads** even as we communicate an overall improvement.

Year-over-year percentage change in rate, 2025 vs. 2024.

Percentage change in rate per 100,000 population, 2025 vs. 2024

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release

PUT IT IN CONTEXT

A modest give-back after a decade of rising severity

WHERE CSI SITS NOW

75.0 / 66

2025 CSI of 75.0 vs. the 2014 low of roughly 66. Even after two years of decline, severity is still ~14% higher than a decade ago.

THE DECADE THAT CAME BEFORE

+22% 2014 → 2024

Violent CSI climbed almost every year from 2014 through 2024. 2025's dip **walks back only a fraction** of that run-up.

SIZE OF THE MOVE

−2.4%

Overall crime rate fell 2.4% and CSI fell 4.86% — **a modest improvement** next to the 20%+ increase in severity accumulated over the prior decade.

DIRECTION OF TRAVEL

2 years down

A second annual decline is **real, not noise** — but one more data point is needed before calling it a durable reversal.

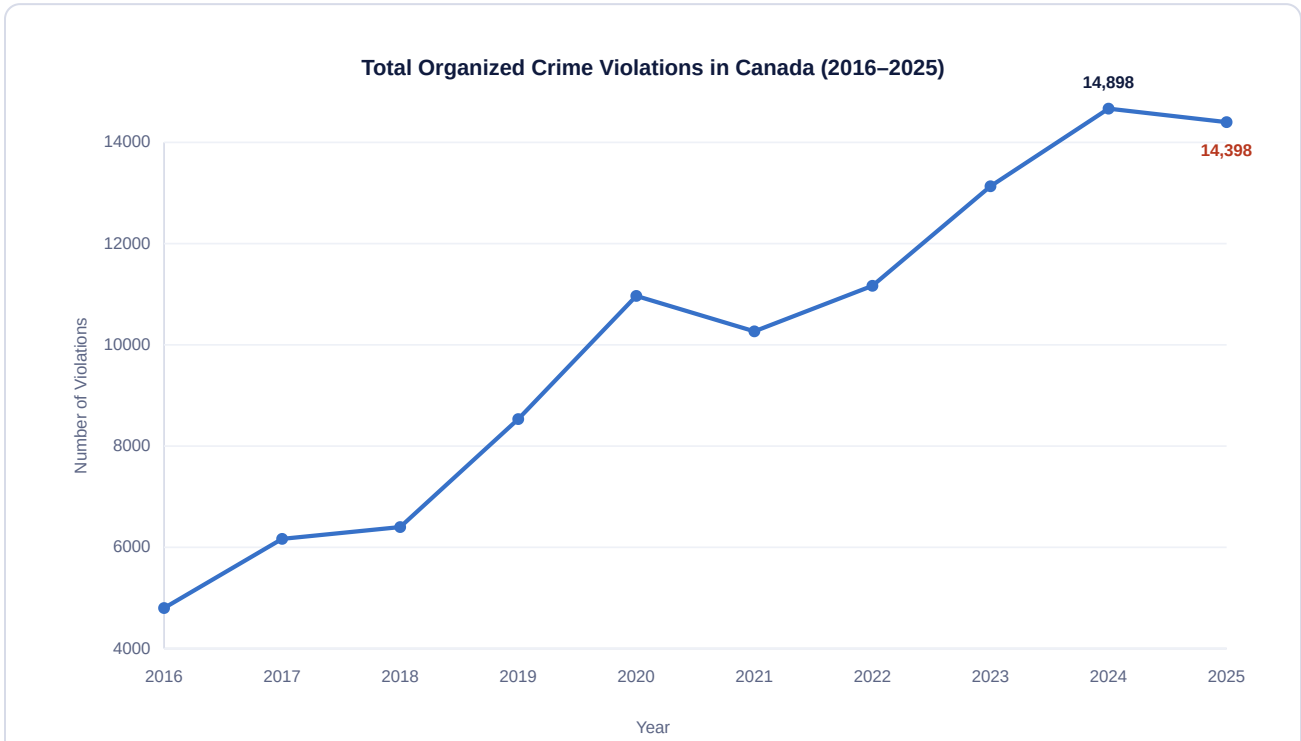
Bottom line: *the direction turned in 2025, but the magnitude is small and the gains are uneven. Communicate an improving trend — and keep resourcing on the serious offences that still moved up.*

Statistics Canada, Crime Severity Index, 2000–2025

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release

ONE TO WATCH

Organized crime — 2025 breaks a 5-year climb



What the line shows

Roughly tripled from 4,810 violations in 2016 to 14,898 in 2024.

First step down in five years

2025 dipped to 14,398 — the first year-over-year decline since 2021, but still nearly 3× the 2016 level.

Where the volume is

Fraud (6,728) and **motor-vehicle theft (1,475)** remain the top two organized-crime charges.

Canada, selected police services

Statistics Canada · July 2026 release